

As I found out by teaching myself to invest and building a portfolio and assets I'm extremely proud of, it takes purpose, intention, education, action, and consistent assessment to do it. But like I said, we are more than capable. With the right resources and education, women are actually better investors (it's a fact!). We approach investing with a long-term mindset focusing on our financial independence, security, and quality of life. We spend a good amount of time researching our investments, which helps us minimize irrational and impulsive decisions, which in turn allows us to make fewer emotionally driven investments. We invest to win for ourselves, not to compete or show off. Plus, we seek help when we need it.⁸

Even despite the odds stacked against us, women have demonstrated that when given the opportunity, we are this good with money. Don't you feel empowered to put those smarts into play for yourself? Regardless of any mistakes you've made with your finances in the past, right now is a great time to grow your knowledge, build up financial confidence, take the actions to get your finances in order, and leverage the power of investing to build long-term wealth for you and your family.

The best part of having this book to guide you is that you won't be doing this alone.

MY INVESTING STORY: THE COMPLETE GAME-CHANGER FOR MY FINANCES

When I started earning my first real salary right out of college, my investment strategy was nonexistent. In fact, investing was the furthest thing from my mind. I had no idea what investing in the stock market was all about or where to even start. As a matter of fact, browsing through my new-hire documentation and seeing the words *401(k)* and *employer-sponsored retirement plan* left me thinking, “Huh?”

I'd never heard of those things before, plus retirement was the last thing on my mind. I was a fresh-faced 24-year-old college grad who was not thinking about anything related to retiring. And if I'm being really honest, I actually initially dismissed the idea of signing up for a 401(k) almost immediately after reading about it, because retirement as it was defined in the guide (age 65) was a whole other lifetime away for me. By then I could